

Quick Reference

Words you'll see in this guide

Word	Meaning
GitHub	The website where Deidra stores the shared project.
Repository	The project's shared folder on GitHub.
Clone	Make your own connected copy of the project on your computer.
Git	The program VS Code uses to copy the repository and track versions.
VS Code	The program used to open the project, view its files, and run the calculator.
Explorer	The file list on the left side of VS Code.
Branch	A version or line of work inside the repository.
main	The current approved branch Christopher should test.
Terminal	The box in VS Code where you give the computer exact instructions.
PowerShell	The Windows program inside the terminal that reads the commands.
Command	One line of text that tells the computer to do one task.
Python	The software language and program used to run the calculator.
Python 3.12	The specific version of Python this project uses.
.venv	The calculator's private project environment for its Python tools.
pip	Python's installer for the software packages the calculator needs.
requirements.txt	The project's list of required Python packages.
Flask	The program that runs the calculator on this computer and lets a browser display it.
Local address	A private address such as <code>http://127.0.0.1:5000</code> that works only on this computer.
Traceback	A detailed Python error report. If one appears, send it to Deidra.

Important terms are also explained again beside the steps where they are used.

Getting the Calculator Ready to Test

From the GitHub invitation to the app running with Flask in VS Code

For Christopher - Product QA

This guide is complete when the calculator is open in a browser, the Welcome screen is visible, and the Flask terminal remains running in VS Code.

What you will need

- [] The GitHub invitation from Deidra
- [] Your GitHub account
- [] Visual Studio Code installed
- [] An internet connection for the first setup
- [] About 15 to 30 minutes for the first setup

Keep the terminal open while testing

The terminal window in VS Code is what keeps the app running. Closing it or stopping the command will close the local app.

How definitions work in this guide

Each unfamiliar word is explained before or beside the step where you need it. Pages 2 and 3 also provide a quick reference.

Part 1 - Accept the repository invitation

Repository

The repository is the shared project folder stored on GitHub.

In this guide: You will accept access to Deidra's repository, then copy it onto your computer.

1 Open the GitHub invitation

Open the invitation email or GitHub notification from Deidra.

2 Accept the invitation

Choose Accept invitation or View invitation, then confirm that you want to join the repository.

3 Open the repository

After accepting, GitHub should take you to the Food Truck Event Profit Calculator repository. Keep this page open.

Part 2 - Copy the repository address

1 Open the Code menu

On the repository page, select the green Code button.

2 Choose the correct copy option

Make sure Local and HTTPS are selected.

3 Copy the address

Select the copy button beside the repository address.

Do not download the ZIP file

Cloning keeps the project connected to GitHub, which makes it much easier to receive later updates.

Part 3 - Clone the project in VS Code

Clone

Cloning creates Christopher's working copy of the repository on his computer and keeps that copy connected to GitHub.

1 Open VS Code

Close any unrelated folders or projects that are already open.

2 Start the clone command

On the VS Code Welcome screen, choose Clone Git Repository. If it is not visible, press Ctrl+Shift+P, type Git: Clone, and choose Git: Clone.

3 Paste the repository address

Paste the address copied from GitHub and press Enter.

4 Choose where the project will live

Choose a normal folder, such as Documents or C:\Projects. VS Code will create the calculator project folder inside it.

5 Open the cloned project

When VS Code asks whether to open the cloned repository, choose Open.

Sign in if prompted

VS Code may open a browser and ask you to authorize GitHub. Sign in with Christopher's GitHub account, approve the request, and return to VS Code.

Confirm the project opened correctly

Explorer

The Explorer is the file list on the left side of VS Code. It shows what is inside the open project.

Look for these project files and folders:

- [] README.md
- [] requirements.txt
- [] app.py
- [] templates
- [] static
- [] tests

If VS Code asks whether you trust the authors

Choose Yes, I trust the authors. This allows VS Code to use the project normally.

Confirm you are on the main branch

Branch and main

A branch is a version of the project. main is the current approved version Christopher should test.

Look at the lower-left corner of VS Code. The branch name should say main. If it says something else, select the branch name and choose main.

If VS Code says Git is not installed

Git

Git is the program VS Code uses to clone the repository and keep it connected to GitHub.

1 Open the Git website

Go to git-scm.com in a browser.

2 Install Git for Windows

Download and install it using the recommended options.

3 Restart VS Code

Close every VS Code window, reopen VS Code, and repeat the cloning steps.

Stop here if the repository will not open

Take a screenshot of the message and send it to Deidra. Do not create a new empty project or download a different copy.

Open the VS Code terminal

Terminal

The terminal is the text area where you will paste commands that prepare and start the calculator.

Command

A command is one exact line of text that tells the computer what to do. Run one command at a time.

1 Open Terminal

At the top of VS Code, select Terminal.

2 Create a new terminal

Select New Terminal.

3 Check the location

The terminal line should end with the project folder name, similar to PS C:\Projects\food-truck-event-profit-calculator>.

What PS means

PS shows that the terminal is using Windows PowerShell. PowerShell is the program that reads the commands in this guide.

How to run each command

Click inside the terminal, copy one command from this guide, paste it, and press Enter. Wait until the normal prompt returns before running the next command.

Part 4 - Check for Python 3.12

Python

Python is the software that runs the calculator. Version 3.12 is the edition this project expects.

Paste this command into the VS Code terminal and press Enter:

```
py -3.12 --version
```

The result you want

Python 3.12.x - the final number can be different.

If Python 3.12 is not found

1 Open the Python download page

Go to python.org/downloads/windows.

2 Install Python 3.12

Download a Python 3.12 installer for Windows. If the installer offers Add Python to PATH, select it.

3 Restart VS Code

Close VS Code completely, reopen the calculator project, create a new terminal, and run the version command again.

Use Python 3.12 for this project

Do not substitute another Python version unless Deidra specifically asks you to.

Part 5 - Create the project environment

Project environment (.venv)

The .venv folder holds a private copy of Python tools for this calculator. It keeps this project's software separate from other apps and projects.

Run:

```
py -3.12 -m venv .venv
```

This command may finish without printing a message. That is normal. Then verify it:

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe --version
```

You should again see Python 3.12.x.

Part 6 - Install the app requirements

pip

pip is Python's installer. It downloads the software pieces the calculator needs.

requirements.txt

requirements.txt is the project's list of the software packages pip should install.

First, update pip inside the project environment:

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip install --upgrade pip
```

Wait until the command finishes and the normal prompt returns.

Next, install everything the calculator needs:

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This is usually the longest step

The terminal will display many lines while it downloads and installs the requirements. Let it finish. Do not close VS Code during this step.

How to know the installation finished

The terminal returns to a line ending with the project folder and a > symbol. The final lines should not contain a red message saying the installation failed.

If the installation fails

Do not keep repeating the command. Send Deidra a screenshot, the last 20 to 30 terminal lines, and the command that was running.

Do not change project files to fix setup problems

Setup errors should be reported before anything in the project is edited.

Part 7 - Start the calculator with Flask

Flask

Flask is the program that starts the calculator on this computer. It connects the project to a web browser so the calculator can be used and tested.

Run this command in the VS Code terminal:

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m flask --app app.py run
```

Local address

A local address opens something running on the same computer. It is private and is not the same as publishing a website online.

In this guide: Flask should display an address similar to `http://127.0.0.1:5000`.

1 Wait for the address

After a moment, the terminal should show Running on `http://127.0.0.1:5000` or a similar local address.

2 Open the calculator

Hold Ctrl and click the address in the terminal. If it does not open, copy the full address and paste it into Chrome, Edge, or another browser.

3 Confirm the calculator opens

The Food Truck Event Profit Calculator should appear. On a new computer, the Welcome screen should normally be first.

4 Leave Flask running

Return to VS Code if needed, but do not close or stop the terminal. You can minimize VS Code while testing in the browser.

Why the Flask command keeps running

That is correct. Flask must remain running so the browser can continue talking to the calculator.

When you are finished testing for the day

- 1 Return to VS Code**
Open the terminal panel where Flask is running.
- 2 Stop Flask**
Click inside the terminal and press Ctrl+C once.
- 3 Wait for the prompt**
The normal PowerShell prompt should return.
- 4 Close the programs**
Close VS Code and the browser when you are ready.

How to open the app next time

- 1 Open the project**
Open VS Code, choose File > Open Recent, and select the calculator project.
- 2 Open a new terminal**
Choose Terminal > New Terminal.
- 3 Start Flask again**
Run the command below.
- 4 Open the address**
Use the local address displayed in the terminal.

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m flask --app app.py run
```

Ready-to-test checklist

- ☐ The GitHub invitation has been accepted.
- ☐ The repository is cloned and open in VS Code.
- ☐ The branch shown in VS Code is main.
- ☐ Python 3.12 is installed.
- ☐ The .venv project environment was created.
- ☐ The requirements installed without an error.
- ☐ The Flask command is running in the VS Code terminal.

- [] The calculator is open in a browser.
- [] The Welcome screen or calculator interface is visible.

You are ready

Once every item above is complete, continue with Christopher's Product Testing Guide and Product Test Data.

Common problems

What happened	What to do
VS Code cannot clone the repository	Confirm the GitHub invitation was accepted. Sign into GitHub in the browser when VS Code asks.
Git is not installed	Install Git for Windows, close VS Code, reopen it, and clone again.
Python 3.12 is not found	Install Python 3.12, close VS Code, reopen it, and retry the version command.
requirements.txt cannot be found	The terminal is not inside the project folder. Reopen the cloned project in VS Code and create a new terminal.
The Flask command keeps running	That is correct. Flask must keep running while the app is open.
The browser cannot connect	Check that the Flask terminal is still running. Use the exact address currently shown in the terminal.
The terminal shows a traceback	A traceback is a detailed error report. Stop and send Deidra a screenshot plus the last terminal lines.

What to send Deidra when something goes wrong

- [] A screenshot that includes the full error message
- [] The exact step you were completing
- [] The command you ran, if the problem happened in the terminal
- [] Whether the app ever opened successfully before the problem

Protect the project copy

Do not delete project files, edit code, or use Clear All Data unless Deidra or the testing guide specifically tells you to.

THE FIXER'S DESK